Thanksgiving Hosting Timeline

A countdown from three weeks out to dinner time. Check things off as you go.

3 WEEKS BEFORE

- [ ] Settle the guest count and the menu
- [ ] Check you have a roasting pan, a meat thermometer and serving dishes
- [ ] Order any tools or dishes you're missing
- [ ] Order or buy the turkey (allow about 1 lb per guest)

2 WEEKS BEFORE

- [ ] Shop for pantry items: broth, canned goods, spices, baking supplies
- [ ] Plan the oven schedule: what bakes when, and what can go in a slow cooker
- [ ] Make and freeze pie dough or rolls

1 WEEK BEFORE

- [ ] Clear fridge space for the turkey and make-ahead dishes
- [ ] Print or bookmark every recipe
- [ ] Write the shopping list for fresh ingredients

THAW TIME (FROZEN TURKEY)

- [ ] Thaw in the fridge: about 1 day for every 4 to 5 lb
- [ ] A 16 lb turkey needs about 4 days, so start the Sunday before
- [ ] Keep it on a tray on the bottom shelf

2 DAYS BEFORE

- [ ] Buy fresh produce, dairy and herbs
- [ ] Make cranberry sauce
- [ ] Chop onions, celery and herbs for stuffing

1 DAY BEFORE

- [ ] Bake pies
- [ ] Assemble make-ahead sides
- [ ] Set the table and lay out serving dishes and utensils

THANKSGIVING DAY

- [ ] Count back from dinner time to set when the turkey goes in
- [ ] Check the turkey with a thermometer: 165°F in the thickest part
- [ ] Rest the turkey about 30 minutes; make gravy from the drippings
- [ ] Keep mashed potatoes or stuffing warm in a slow cooker

AFTER DINNER

- [ ] Refrigerate leftovers within 2 hours
- [ ] Use leftovers within 3 to 4 days, or freeze them

Notes for your dinner

Kitchen tools for the day: kitchenfindsfavorites.com/gifts/thanksgiving-kitchen-checklist/